

Unit 14 Sikhism

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the nature of Sikhism and its effects on the lives of Sikh believers in the UK. There are four sections covering beliefs and values, community and tradition, worship and celebration, and living the Sikh life.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.

Detailed unit content

Section 14.1 Beliefs and values

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — Akal Purakh, gurbani, gurmat, haumai, hukam, Ik onkar, karma, meeri-peeri, Mool Mantar, Sat-Nam, varna, Waheguru

- The meaning and importance of the nature and attributes of God as expressed in the Mool Mantar (Akal Purakh, Satnam, Waheguru).
- The meaning and importance of believing in God as the Eternal One.
- The meaning and importance of believing in God as the Creator.
- The meaning and importance of believing in God as the Teacher.
- The meaning and importance of believing in karma and rebirth.
- The meaning and importance of believing in manmukh, gurmukh and the elimination of haumai.
- The meaning and importance of believing in mukti and union with God.
- The meaning and importance of the rejection of the caste system.
- The meaning and importance of the equal status of men and women.
- The importance of social service in living the spiritual life.
- The importance of social justice in living the spiritual life.